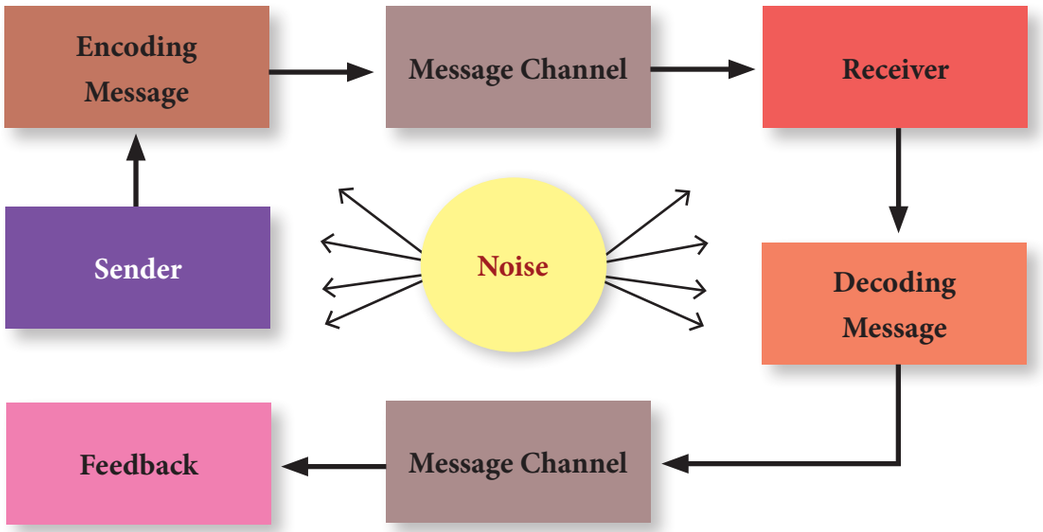
THE COMMUNICATION PROCESS



10.4 WHY COMMUNICATION IS IMPORTANT IN NURSING

Communication in nursing is essential in patient safety, health and well-being, because nurses are at the centre of patient care, it is their responsibility to facilitate dialog. As nurses assume more complex roles and care for all age group and different culture people, they will need to strengthen their communication skills.

1. Helps to understand and to exchange ideas to the patient, relatives, doctors and other health care team members.
2. Generate trust between nurse and patients.
3. Reduces the interpersonal tensions and improves interpersonal relationship.
4. Helps to modify the nurses behaviour
5. Helps to influence others behaviour
6. Prevent disorder in the ward
7. Provides effective leadership

When you can present your own ideas dearly, specifically, visually, and most important, contextually – in the context of a deep understanding of another's paradigms and concerns – you significantly increase the credibility of your ideas.

- Stephen R.Covey

10.4.1 The following are Simple Guidelines Nurses can follow to improve their Communications Skills.

Be Flexible

Every person has a preferred method of communicating, whether in-person, by phone or via the internet.

Learn to Listen

Speaking and writing are only part of communicating — listening is equally essential. With improper listening properly, they will miss important information of the patient. Listening errors are often the results of multitasking.

Do not make Assumptions

Assuming a patient knows what you mean can result in costly errors. Nurses can ask patients to repeat instructions, which can reveal any misunderstandings or gaps in information.

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